Question 1

What kinds of games do you usually play, and what do you enjoy about them?

Hard, fighting, strategy, challenge, thrilling, war thunder, hell divers, military, empire at war (modded) total war games

- What keeps you interested in those games?
- Do you usually play alone or with other people?
- Do you prefer games that are new, or do you often return to older games?

2000+ average 2010s, older games (modded), else newer

Question 2

Think about the last new game you bought or seriously considered playing. Walk me through how you decided whether to try it.

Ace combat 8. Fits with normal types of games (military, challenging, fighting). Played earlier version(brand loyalty, ace combat 7).

- How did you first hear about it?

  Ace combat 7: given as a gift ace combat 8: spoiler free reviews with positive ratings (youtube)

- What made you interested?
- What concerns did you have? Ace combat 8: will be as fun as ace combat 7, possible nostalgia coloring vies, pricy (80), worried about lack of difficulty and too short of length.
- What finally convinced you to try it or decide against it?

Question 3

Where do you usually look for information about a game before playing it?

1) **Youtubers**
2) **word of mouth from game friends**
3) **steam sales**

- Do you read written reviews?
- Do you watch gameplay videos? second
- Do you check player reviews on a store page? steam
- Do you ask friends? biggest
- Do you use different sources for different games?

  Brand loyalty

Question 4

What information are you trying to find before deciding whether to play a game?

People user trusts on if they like the game or not

Possible follow-ups:

- Do you care about performance and bugs? yes
- Do you want to know how the gameplay works? yes
- Does the price affect your decision? yes
- Do you want to know whether a game is still receiving updates? Yes (newer)
- Do you care about multiplayer activity? yes
- or whether a game is still popular? Sometimes

  Mostly within users interests!!!

Question 5

Have you ever found that different sources disagreed about a game? How did you decide which one to trust?

Yes: friends and sources

1) **Is it in users interests?**
2) **Brand loyalty**

- Did you look for additional reviews? Gameplay on youtube
- Did you pay attention to how many people had reviewed it? No (right people aka friends)
- Did you look for specific examples or explanations?

- Did you decide that you couldn't trust any of the sources? Game journalists: found opinions ane games did not align with user’s interest

Question 6

What makes you trust or distrust a game review?

Questions user asks: Do they care about politics? Has a reviewer said other things about games the user likes?

- Does it matter who wrote it? yes
- Do you trust reviews more when they explain their reasoning? yes
- Does the reviewer's experience with that type of game matter?yes
- Does the number of reviews affect your confidence? Not really

Question 7

Have you ever felt that reviews gave you the wrong impression of a game?

Not really, friends and youtube gameplay

Spoilers?

Watch spoiler free videos

- What did the reviews fail to explain?
- Was the information outdated?
- Did the game change significantly after release?
- Did the reviewers care about different things than you did?

Question 8

What problems have you noticed with online game reviews or ratings?

Biased for reasons others than gameplay (helldivers: pride cape, politics)

- Fake or misleading reviews.
- Review bombing. (politics)
- Old reviews that no longer reflect the game.
- Different websites giving conflicting ratings.
- Reviews that explain a score poorly.

Question 9

What would you expect a website like that to help you do?

Filter games by genre, difficulty, system filters (ex: windows pc, ps5)

- Would you want to compare different games? Yes: games user has played and compare to new games, filter by category, minimize personal and political opinions
- Would you want to see reviews from multiple sources on one page? Yes, possibly filter by types of reviews, tags and by game reviewers

Question 10

How would you want the website to present ratings from different sources?

Comparison of scores by the same source for other games they have reviewed

- Would you want to see each source's score separately? yes
- Would you want an explanation of how a combined score was calculated? yes
- Would you want to know how many reviews contributed to the score? yes

Question 11

What would make you distrust a website that combines game reviews?

No politics

- Would you worry that some sources were being ignored? yes
- Would you want to see where each rating came from? yes
- Would you worry that the combined score hid important differences of opinion? yes
- Would you want to know when the reviews were published? yes

Question 12

Can you imagine a situation in which you would use this website? What would you be trying to accomplish?

If the website has a good track record and proved it rated games fairly: if user was bored with the games he has and is looking to try something new

- Would you use it when a game was on sale? yes

- Would you use it to compare games in the same genre? yes
- Would you use it when a game received a major update? Yes (less) (downloaded fortnight to play for one update to play as darth vader)
- Are there mods on the game? yes

Question 13

If you could change one thing about how game reviews work today, what would it be?

Come back

Question 14

Is there anything important about choosing games or trusting reviews that I haven't asked you about?

modding

Question 15

Do you think your approach to reviews differs from that of other gamers you know? If so, how?

Not really

Linking steam account to bring friends reviews to the top of the list (gabe nual)
If we could only pick one place to get reviews from: steam
Reedit: maybe. No politics